

N14 RED AND PROCESSED MEATS | O (MAX : 1 PT)

Intent : Increase the availability of plant-based food options and reposition red and processed meat products to decrease their prominence at point-of-decision.

Summary : This WELL feature requires providing plant-based food options, limiting the portion size of red meat and decreasing the prominence of red and processed meats.

Issue : The consumption of meat, including red and processed meat, has been increasing worldwide, a trend with major health and environmental consequences.¹ In 2015, the World Health Organization classified processed meat as carcinogenic (cancer-causing) and red meat as probably carcinogenic.² Processed meat includes meat that has been processed through salting, smoking, curing or other processes to improve flavor or preservation while red meat includes unprocessed mammalian muscle meat such as beef, veal, pork and lamb.² Although red meat is a source of protein and minerals and vitamins, such as iron and vitamin B12, many studies show that a high intake of red meat is associated with an increased risk of colorectal cancer, heart disease, diabetes and other chronic diseases.²⁻⁴ Consumption of processed meat is more strongly associated with colorectal cancer and also positively associated with stomach cancer.² Globally, food production practices that support the consumption of plant-based foods, including meat alternatives, are more likely to contribute to a sustainable food system and healthier environment for all.⁵

Solutions : Providing plant-based meat alternatives, reducing the portion size of red meat servings and repositioning meat products has the potential to decrease the demand for and consumption of meat.⁶ The World Cancer Research Fund recommends that individuals who consume red meat limit their intake to no more than three portions per week (equivalent to 350–500 g per week) and to avoid eating processed meat.⁷ Plant-based protein sources such as nuts, legumes (pulses) and cereals (grains) as well as poultry, fish, eggs and dairy are valuable sources of protein and nutrients and are recommended alternatives to red meat.⁷ Smaller portions and leaner cuts of red meat are also encouraged for individuals who normally consume red meat.⁷ In food service, chefs and menu developers can help shift eating patterns by positioning red meat as a supplement (side dish) or condiment to plant-based dishes and by limiting processed meat options.⁸

PART 1 LIMIT RED AND PROCESSED MEATS (MAX : 1 PT)

For Commercial Dining Spaces:

Foods and beverages are sold or provided by (or under contract with) the project owner on a daily basis and meet the following requirements, as applicable:

- a. At least one plant-based option is available at each food outlet.⁸
- b. A single portion or serving of red meat, if sold or provided, is less than 150 g uncooked weight or less than 115 g cooked weight.⁷
- c. Red and processed meats, if sold or provided, are placed at the end of self-serve food service lines.⁶
- d. Red and processed meats, if sold or provided, are listed last in each menu section or listed on a separate menu and/or menu board.⁹

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